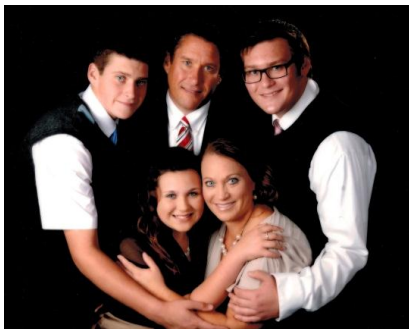




## The Dana and Shannon Gorbahn Christmas Letter – 2012

We send you a special Christmas wish, that your life will be brighter and happier, this day and for every day of the rest of your life. This is, and should be “the most wonderful time of the year”. It is a season of being more reflective about our own lives and about the many blessings that are ours. Of which, we are most thankful!

**Family Highlights:** Kai moved back home at the earlier part of the year. After a few years, both Michael and Jessica have moved out of the home and are living with a new family. We miss them. We have gone from 6 kids to 2 our home is very quiet. Everyone, except Kai went away on a 12 Day Hawaiian Cruise in September. It was wonderful. While we were gone, we had major renovations on our home. We expanded our family room by getting rid of a hallway and another bedroom; and we got ourselves a whole new floor plan for our kitchen, dining room, and reading area. We are very happy with the results and love our house. Kai then moved back to Vancouver and shortly after that, Taaron moved out. Now the house is not as busy.

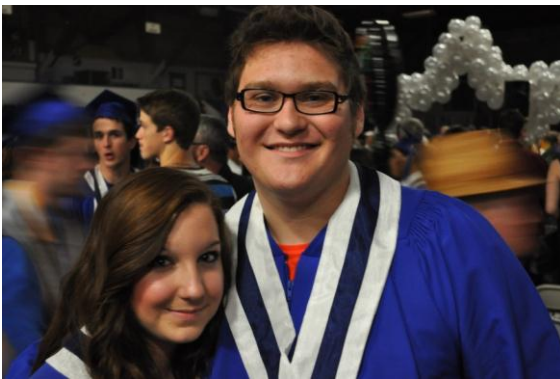


**Jadyn:** Hey, My life is going well, I'm selling Avon and its great I just made \$80 it was more but me and my mom shared it. I'm now in Dance (JAZZ) its lots of fun. Every week it gets harder and harder but I practice at home. I'm really excited for Christmas!!! In my room I have 3 countdowns in different spots. I've been loving hanging out with my friends, my best friend is Chloe, and we do everything together. Chloe and I listen to music every lunch. I'm into Taylor Swift, Justin Bieber and Katy Perry. I'm really hoping to go to Taylor Swift RED, I think Katy Perry's would be Fun with candy theme and all. DAD when u read this can u please help me with the ending. I can't think of anything☺ Thanks: P



**Kaleb:** Hello everyone!! I hope you are all doing great! This year for me has had a lot of ups and downs, but I'm not sure if I would change that. I've learned so much from the experiences I've had. Good and bad, thanks to these experiences I can make 2013 a year to remember. But I might as well tell you about the highlights of my year. The first thing which I'm happy about was being named MVP in all of the sports I played this year. Basketball, volleyball and of course golf. I'm really starting to become an all-around athlete and I hope to improve on these things more and more. But I'm also very proud to say that I am most certainly not just a one trick pony. The play we did last school year was called “Fame” and I got a lead role in

this musical. But working on this production was not easy. If you know me, you would know I'm not much for dancing; but my character was a dancer, so I had to work hours and hours learning and perfecting ballet. That was not something I wanted to do in my spare time. But thankfully, I won't have to do that again. This year we are doing the Shakespeare play Macbeth, and I was casted as Macduff; which I am really excited to be since that was the part I asked for in my audition. This summer was fun. I got to go to a BYU golf camp and meet the coach. He's a great guy and he seemed to really be fond of me and my golf game, so I hope that might lead to something in the future. I played in many tournaments, and even had the lead in a big one at one point but hitting a rock on my downswing and severely hurt my wrist and hand; which destroyed my chances of winning. I also got to have my dad caddy for me. It was so much fun. Unfortunately I didn't make the cut for being given a two stroke penalty and I missed the cut my two but I know I'll do better this coming year with my dad on the bag again! Well, that's probably most of my highlights. I love you all! And I hope that you have a great up and coming year. I can't wait to see you! Love always. Kaleb.



**Taaron:** Hey everyone, it has been one long year! Remember how last year I was an extra on the set of the Liam Neeson film 'The Grey'? Well it just so happens that for the one take I went to the bathroom was just the take they decided to use, so alas, I am not in a Liam Neeson movie...Other than that, it has been a year of changes. I graduated early from high school and hung around for a while before starting to work full time and live on my own in an apartment. After moving back home and then promptly moving back out again, I now live meters from my workplace! So... hooray? I have also had the opportunity to go on a couple of really cool trips this year. For a graduation present, my dad took me to New York City which was an unbelievable experience and I

was incredibly blessed to spend the entire week with my dad. After the summer, the family (excluding Kai, hahahah) went on a cruise from Vancouver to Hawaii, which was super fun. After so much time living away from my wonderful family, I got a chance to spend some quality time with them. I still have my love for films and filmmaking; I am currently hard at work on a production called 'Dazed and Aware' (feel free to check out the Facebook page!) along with several other short films and videos which has been a wonderful creative outlet for me. I have also been spending time day dreaming business ideas as another way to learn and be creative in a different field. You can watch some of my videos at [vimeo.com/taarongorbahn](http://vimeo.com/taarongorbahn). I have launched a website devoted to independent content and creators called [indieandup.com](http://indieandup.com) which I intend to grow as an online publication while I am going to school. Along with this site, I have been developing more to help gain relevant work experience. In the spring I will be moving to Victoria with my wonderful girlfriend, Chloe, to attend school for marketing. We are both very excited to be taking these huge steps with each other's support and love. With all the cool and interesting things I have been working on and planning and experiencing; I have been realizing more and more the importance of learning and comprehension. Everything is a learning experience and the importance of being able to understand your own experiences is paramount to advancing further in life. In addition to understanding yourself, take the time to speak with those around you and to listen to what they are saying, be an open ear and take the time to understand those important people in your life. Until next time.

**Kai:** My life has been a fantastic blur. I lived in Vancouver, lived in Smithers, and then came back to Vancouver. Who knows where I'll be next!? (But I'm hoping to change the pattern!) The major thing that happened was that my novel got published in April. It was warmly received. Never made the big bucks on it, though. Oh well! Next one will be much more marketable. Something more grandeurish, that could catch on like Twilight or Hunger Games. I don't know what it will be, but I'm getting tons of inspiration from the city. Right now I work a really strange job that I won't bother



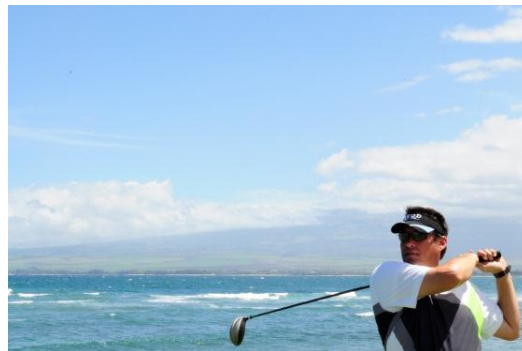


trying to explain, but it's cool because I get to work with all actors and actresses. Life is going good. I hope you all have an excellent Christmas.



**Shannon:** I have had a wonderful year with many highlights. Firstly after 19 years of fostering we decided it was time to retire. We have had many, many wonderful children come through our home, we have been greatly blessed and challenged, however it was time. Jady and I spent a wonderful week in Arizona together in July and of course our amazing cruise to Hawaii with our kids, minus Kai as he was looking after the store and getting ready to move to Vancouver when we arrived back. I drove Kai and helped get him all moved in to his little basement suite, happy day for Kai and a sad day for mom. I have been enjoying taking on a bigger role at the store and working a few shifts a week. We are so blessed with our amazing family, good friends and health. Thinking of you all during this beautiful Christmas season.

**Dana:** Got lots to be grateful for. Did lots!! I've been busy with my work and the responsibilities of that. In January, Luke and I met in Phoenix to stay at our house and play a few rounds of golf. Luke brought some friends. Later, Shannon and I went to Vancouver for a weekend together and took a Thai Cooking Course. Kaleb and I went to Myrtle Beach for another Father/Son Golf Trip. My friend Richard came along. Kaleb beat me virtually every time; but after this summer, I can't come close to him. I also went skydiving! What a rush! I still coach his high school golf team and we came out as winners of the zone and competed very well in Provincials. I took Kaleb to Salt Lake to the BYU elite golf camp. I got to see Marinda and John and their family. From there, I flew to New York City and met Taaron there for his graduation present; and we took in the sites and went to plays and watched the filming of Letterman. We had a great time! During the summer, I took Kaleb around to some big golf tournaments down to the Vancouver area. My highlight was being able to caddy for him in the BC Amateur. It's the only tournament so far, where he is allowed to have an adult as his caddy. To me, it was even better than playing; cause, he can hit the shots that we talk about, but if it was me, we couldn't expect the shot to go where we would want it. That was fun!! I got called to be the 1<sup>st</sup> Councillor in the District Presidency. As I mentioned, it was great to go on the cruise with the family. And shortly after that, Kai and I went down to Phoenix to our home to paint the bathroom, do some house work and yard work and of course, golf. On our way back, we had a night in Las Vegas.



**Gorbahn Challenge:** Well it has fizzled out; but given that the only time Luke and I got together to golf (in Phoenix); I won each and every round. We did not get together to do the other events, so based on past practice, Dana should be, and is declared the champion of the Gorbahn Challenge.